Big-Ticket Refresh Wish List

The dreams that decluttering reminds you of. Park them here, plan them kindly.

How to use this page

While spring cleaning you'll spot the things that cleaning can't fix — sagging mattress, blinds near death, that one reliable-but-ugly chair. Write them here instead of buying mid-sweep. Then let the sheet sit: items that still seem worth it in a month are the real list. Earmark a small monthly amount if a line item keeps calling to you.

The wish list

ITEM / PROJECT	ROOM / AREA	EST. COST	PRIORITY (1–3)	WANTED SINCE	NOTE / WHERE TO BUY

Prioritize with three passes

1. **Safety & function first** — leaking, wiring, mold or damp, failing things that damage the house. These outrank everything pretty.
2. **Daily-drag fixers** — the item that annoys you every single day wins over the item that would impress twice a year.
3. **Joy purchases** — guilt-free. A home that sparks warmth is a real goal; this pass exists precisely so you can say yes to one lovely thing.

> **The 30-day hold**
>
> Enter the date in “Wanted since.” If a month passes and you still want it, price it properly (new, used, sale) and put the first dollar aside. Wanting something through a whole laundry cycle and a bad week is a decent proxy for actually wanting it.

Tips before buying big

- [ ] Check if it's repairable
  A $40 fix on a $400 habit item often outruns a $400 replace.
- [ ] Measure twice, including doorways & stairs
- [ ] Check outlet/valve/hookup compatibility first
- [ ] Sell the old one on the same day it leaves — drama-free
- [ ] Does it need a maintenance cal? Add small annual item here instead of a wish
- [ ] Free options first: freecycle, marketplace, curb alerts, hand-me-downs
- [ ] Budget line item gets a name (“New Curtain Fund”); named money moves

Replace-or-repair quick check

ASK	IF YES →	IF NO →
Is a basic repair < 30% of replacement?	Repair	Keep wish-listing
Does it still do its job safely?	Repair or live with	Replace soon
Has it failed twice already?	Replace	One more repair is fine
Would the new one save energy/water?	Do the payback math (often 2–5 yr)	Skip the upgrade
Parts no longer available?	Plan replacement	Repair confidently

This page — plus a small auto-transfer with a dream's name on it — is how “someday” becomes a delivery date. Keep it with your pack and update it each spring.